

► **Problem:** You get a buffer underrun error.

Cause: Almost all CD/DVD recorders come with a small amount of buffer memory to smooth out the burning process. The buffer reads ahead and provides the data required for burning in a linear manner. A buffer underrun error happens when the data source slows down for some reason. Since the CD is spinning and there is no data to be burnt, it causes the burning process to be aborted, resulting in a coaster.

Solution: Unless you have a really old drive, you shouldn't see this error. In fact, almost all recorders today have hardware support to ensure buffer underruns don't occur. Moreover, burning software also have support for this feature - make sure you activate it; it's just a matter of checking a box. If you have a drive that does not support this feature, make sure you use your hard drive as the data source, since a CD to CD copy will definitely result in a coaster. Also, defragment your hard disk regularly to avoid a slow-down during the burning process.

► **Problem:** Despite the write process completing, a CD turns up blank.

Cause: It's not clear why this happens.

Solution: Try using different media. Go to the burning software's Web site and check whether any patches to fix the problem have been released. Sometimes, these patches will fix such an issue, if they don't, try an alternative application.

► **Problem:** A recorder won't work with blank CD-RWs.

Cause: This is a common problem. CD-RWs are rated as Slow (1x to 4x), High Speed (4x to 10x), Ultra Speed (12x to 24x), and Ultra Speed+ (for drives supporting even higher burning speeds).

Solution: Choose the correct CD-RW media depending on the burning speed supported by your drive. Also, if you're trying to use an Ultra Speed + media, it might not get detected, whereas a lower-speed media will get burnt at its maximum speed.

► **Problem:** Video DVDs stutter.

Cause: This is a common problem with most DVD players. During video playback, most drives drop down to a lower speed to cut